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Task One

Craft a phishing email simulation to be used to raise awareness of one of the most common threats...

Easy

30-60 mins

2

Task Two

...

Easy

30-60 mins

P

Finish Line

...

Easy

Achievements

Why this is important ⓘ

Task 1: Design a phishing email simulation

1

2

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7

8

## Task Overview

**What you'll learn**

- What threat phishing presents to an organization
- What different types of phishing emails look like
- How Mastercard prevents and mitigates phishing threats

**What you'll do**

- Examine an obvious fake email and make it more believable

?

Next

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## Let's give you some context

You are an analyst in our **Security Awareness Team**.

Our Chief Security Officer (CSO) relies on our team to help our staff learn how to identify and report security threats to Mastercard.

One of the most common threats organizations face today is **phishing**. So, what is phishing?

- Phishing is the act of pretending to be someone/something to get information, in most cases, this is usually a password.
- Attackers may send links or attachments designed to infect the recipient's system with malicious software or lure them into providing financial information, system credentials or other sensitive data.
- Successful phishing attempts can cost companies like Mastercard millions of dollars and put our employees at risk. So it's very important that we keep the business and our staff safe from harm.

At Mastercard, one of the ways we mitigate phishing threats is by educating our people about the risks and how to identify them. An effective way to build awareness is through **phishing simulation campaigns**:

- We test our staff every month by sending a fake phishing email that is made to look like something a bad actor would send.
- We use the results of the simulated test to help us design and implement future training.



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## What can a phishing email look like?

A few months back, we detected a phishing email that was being used by an external bad actor on some of our employees.

Thankfully, it failed due to being an **obvious fake**. However, we know that phishing emails are now getting very sophisticated and a range of tactics are used.

Start the quick quiz to learn what an 'obvious fake' might look like.



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## Task 1: Design a phishing email simulation

## Question 1 of 2

### What is the first issue you spot in this phishing email?

**From:** mastercardsIT@gmail.com  
**To:** employee@email.com  
**Subject:** URGENT! Password Reset Required

**Body:**  
Hello (insert name)...

Your email account has been compromised. immediate action is required to reset your password!

Click here to reset your password in the next hour or your account will be locked:  
<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phishing>

Regards,  
Mastercard IT



The email looks legitimate



Suspicious looking source email address



The subject line says URGENT!

**Great Work!**

Correct! First of all, there is a typo in the email address. You can also see that it is coming from gmail, not a Mastercard email.

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Question 2 of 2

### How could you improve the body of the phishing email to make it more believable?

**From:** mastercardsIT@gmail.com  
**To:** employee@email.com  
**Subject:** URGENT! Password Reset Required

**Body:**  
Hello (insert name) .

Your email account has been compromised. immediate action is required to reset your password!

Click here to reset your password in the next hour or your account will be locked:  
<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phishing>

Regards,  
Mastercard IT

☐ Write more text

☐ Suspicious or unusual attachments

☒ Improve the spelling, grammar & sloppy layout

☐ Nothing! This email is expertly put together.

☒ **Great Work!**  
That's right - in addition to this, the hyperlink could be masked in plain text.

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#### Achievements

Why this is important ⓘ

#### Task 1: Design a phishing email simulation

## Your task is to create a believable phishing email

Your manager wants you to lead Mastercard's next phishing simulation campaign. This is an awesome opportunity for you to step up and show what you can do.

The first step is to create the fake phishing email to use in the simulation.

You've just seen what an 'obvious fake' looks like, so it's important to make yours **contextual** and **believable** to increase the likelihood of an employee clicking on the phishing link.

Click next to get started on your phishing email.



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## Improve the phishing email

Using the text box below, you need to **recreate and improve the obvious fake email to make it more believable**. Remember the end goal is to encourage the user to click on the link.

To create a 'good' phishing email, you should:

- Add some context at the beginning - make it relevant to a Mastercard employee
- Mask the hyperlink within text
- Use correct spelling and grammar
- Add points of legitimacy

Once you've submitted your email, we'll show you an example of a good phishing email.

Here is the obvious fake:

From: mastercardsIT@mail.com  
To: employee@email.com  
Subject: URGENT! Password Reset Required-

Body:

Hello (insert name) ,

Your email account has been compromised. immediate action is required to reset your password!

Click here to reset your password in the next hour or your account will be locked: [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phishing](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Phishing)

Regards,Mastercard IT

**Estimated time for task completion: 30 minutes depending on your learning style.**

**B I S U** | **≡ ≡**

Dear [Employee name],

As part of our routine security monitoring, we detected unusual login activity on your employee account. To ensure uninterrupted access to internal systems, please verify your credentials immediately.

Click here to securely reset your password: [reset password]

If you do not complete this verification within 60 minutes, access to your account will be temporarily suspended in accordance with Mastercard's security policy.

Thank you,

Mastercard IT Security Team

**NEW YORK CITY  
FIRE DEPARTMENT**

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## Example Phishing Email

Great attempt!

There are many ways you could have attempted this task, as phishing emails come in all shapes sizes. Below you'll find one example of an improved phishing email - take note of some of the improvements made.

This is one example of an improved phishing email.  
There are many different ways you could have done this.

Spelling of Mastercard fixed and email comes from a relatable address

**From:** Mastercard Staff Rewards  
**To:** employee@email.com  
**Subject:** Your Black Friday Employee reward card

Email is personalized and poor grammar is fixed

**Body:**  
Hello <name>.

Contextualize to upcoming Black Friday event

In recognition of your hard work throughout the year, we wish to reward you with a gift card to spend in the upcoming Black Friday sales as a small token of our appreciation. Please find attached your Employee reward card.

Link is masked in plaintext to hide phishing link

The balance of your card will be determined based on your role. To view the balance and activate your employee reward card, visit [here](#).

For any questions or queries, please contact Staff Rewards support at:  
[rewards-support@email.com](mailto:rewards-support@email.com)

To increase legitimacy, buffer text is added

From,  
Staff Reward Services

**CONFIDENTIAL:** This email and any files transmitted with it are confidential and intended solely for the use of the individual or entity to whom they are addressed. If you have received this email in error please notify the system manager. This message contains confidential information and is intended only for the individual named. If you are not the named addressee you should not disseminate, distribute or copy this e-mail. Please notify the sender immediately by e-mail if you have received this e-mail by mistake and delete this e-mail from your system. If you are not the intended recipient you are notified that disclosing, copying, distributing or taking any action in reliance on the contents of this information is strictly prohibited.

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